

1 ENGROSSED HOUSE
2 BILL NO. 4434

By: Hilbert of the House

3 and

4 Paxton of the Senate
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8 An Act relating to state government; requiring the
9 Governor to provide certain notification; requiring
10 notification to indicate start of absence and
11 anticipated return; directing notice be made twenty-
four hours before absence except for emergencies;
providing for codification; and providing an
effective date.

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14 BE IT ENACTED BY THE PEOPLE OF THE STATE OF OKLAHOMA:

15 SECTION 1. NEW LAW A new section of law to be codified
16 in the Oklahoma Statutes as Section 8.20 of Title 74, unless there
17 is created a duplication in numbering, reads as follows:

18 Notification, as provided in this section, shall be required
19 when the Governor is absent from the state. Except in the event of
20 an emergency, at least twenty-four (24) hours prior to the Governor
21 being absent from the state, the Governor shall provide electronic
22 notification to the Lieutenant Governor of his or her plans to be
23 absent from the state, indicating the start date and time and the
24 anticipated return date and time in such notification. The

notification required by this section shall also be required of the acting Governor, when he or she is absent from the state, and follow the line of succession provided in Section 15 of Article VI of the Oklahoma Constitution or as may be provided by law. In the event of an emergency, notice shall be provided prior to being absent from the state.

SECTION 2. This act shall become effective January 11, 2027.

Passed the House of Representatives the 24th day of March, 2026.

Presiding Officer of the House
of Representatives

Passed the Senate the _____ day of _____, 2026.

Presiding Officer of the Senate